

Lincoln & Lindsey
Blind Society

Living Well Together Strategy

2025 - 2030

Introduction

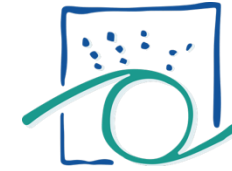


For over 100 years, LLBS has stood beside visually impaired people across Greater Lincolnshire.

As demand grows and the world evolves, we set out in 2025 to re-imagine how we can best support our community for the years ahead.

Through heartfelt conversations, surveys, data and strategy days with members, trustees, staff, volunteers and partners, we listened deeply to what matters most. This collective insight has shaped a clear, community-led direction that will guide our work over the next five years - strengthening connection, expanding opportunity, and helping people with sight loss thrive.

Who we are here for



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LLBS supports **people with vision impairments** to live independently and with dignity across Greater Lincolnshire.

- **1,600+ people supported**, across **16,000 square miles of largely rural communities**
- Many face **isolation, reduced confidence, limited transport, digital barriers, and lack of local services**
- Vision impairment often brings **sudden, life-changing challenges** requiring timely, practical support

Our response

- Personal, one-to-one support delivered in **homes and communities**
- Focused on **maintaining and rebuilding independence**
- Delivered by **specialist sight impairment officers and volunteers** with deep local knowledge

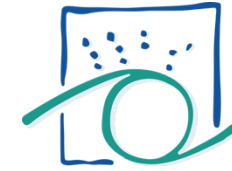
Why this matters

- Support is only effective if **people know it exists**
- We want a **greater impact for existing members** and to reach those **not yet connected to us**

“Some days I cope well, and other days I don’t — my needs change all the time. Knowing LLBS understands that and helps me adapt has made me feel less alone and more in control of my life.”



Summary Analysis 2025



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Strengths

- Trusted, face-to-face support that many people rely on as a lifeline.
- Empathetic, lived-experience-led delivery by staff and volunteers.
- Flexible, holistic services tailored to individual needs.
- Longstanding and only local provider across Greater Lincolnshire.
- Good reputation with funders and proven ability to deliver impact.

Weaknesses

- Capacity and access stretched: Demand exceeds staff; transport, rurality, and volunteer gaps limit reach.
- Key-person risk: Heavy reliance on a small number of individuals.
- Brand unclear: “Blind” and geographic naming cause confusion
- Digital risk: Weak online presence and unmaintainable data systems raise admin and cyber risk.
- Reach gaps: Low awareness among younger adults, families, and diverse communities.

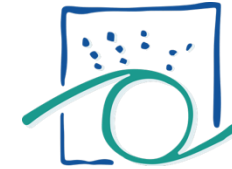
Opportunities

- Broaden reach through modern, accessible engagement.
- Deliver flexible support using digital, in-person, and peer models.
- Close the digital gap with skills, tools, and access.
- Extend impact through strategic partnerships.
- Strengthen income via collaboration and services.

Threats

- Unstable funding and policy changes threaten long-term sustainability.
- Limited capacity and skills across volunteers, staff, and trustees.
- Rising and more complex client needs exceed current resources.
- Rapid technology change and cyber risk challenge capability and resilience.
- Accessibility and transport barriers limit reach, especially in rural areas.

Our vision, mission and values guide all our work



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VISION

Our vision is that all visually impaired people in Greater Lincolnshire feel confident, connected, and supported to live life their way.

MISSION

We provide personal, practical, and lifelong support for people affected by visual impairment across Greater Lincolnshire. We help people stay independent, overcome isolation, and belong to a caring local community.

VALUES

Personal

We know people by name and treat everyone with warmth, respect and understanding - no matter their age, background or experiences of sight loss.

Community

We are rooted in Greater Lincolnshire's communities and reach those who are rural or isolated.

Reliable

We show up, for as long as needed, and keep our promises - we are open, honest and fair.

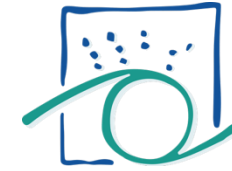
Empowering

We build confidence, not dependency. We focus on what works and what makes daily life better

Collaborative

We work with families, volunteers, and partners to deliver our mission.

Living Well Together Strategy 2025-30



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Theme	Starting Point (2025)	Intended Direction	Intended Outcomes (2030)
 Community	Limited daytime, in-person social and community groups.	Expand inclusive community connection through a wider mix of in-person and digital opportunities, across locations and times.	Vision impaired people and their loved ones feel supported, connected, and part of a community - with engagement at least doubled from 2025.
 Transport	No specific transport offerings, biggest barrier for members	Work with partners to improve access to transport solutions that enable participation in community life.	Members are better able to get out, access services, and engage in their communities.
 Wellbeing	Individual support, befriending, and referrals to partner services.	Strengthen wellbeing support through partnerships, peer connection, and accessible options that reflect changing needs.	Members report improved wellbeing, confidence, and resilience.
 Future Ready	Established ways of working that require review to meet future needs.	Strengthen governance, systems, engagement, and ways of working to support sustainable growth and impact.	A resilient, well-governed charity able to support people for as long as needed.

This strategy sets direction and outcomes. Specific actions will be developed through detailed theme plans and member engagement.

Strategy Timeline



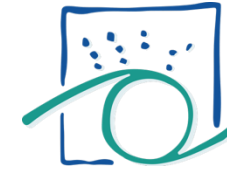
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Theme	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Community					
Transport					
Wellbeing					
Future Ready					

- The Future Ready theme enables the delivery of all other themes.
- The themes have been sequenced to ensure any dependencies between themes have been taken into account, along with considering the impact on resources.



Community



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Intended Outcomes

Vision impaired people and their loved ones feel supported, connected, and part of a community - with engagement at least doubled from 2025.

Why

Because sight loss often shrinks people's worlds, and LLBS exists to restore belonging, connection, and confidence through trusted local relationships.

LLBS Member "You feel like you belong as part of a community"

Intended Direction

LLBS will prioritise **connection and belonging** as core outcomes of its work, ensuring that vision impaired people and their families feel supported, involved, and able to shape solutions that matter to them.

Community will remain the foundation of LLBS's approach - reducing isolation, strengthening confidence, and enabling people to live well together.

Reason

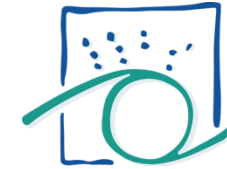
- Nearly half of survey respondents identified **social groups and connection** as one of the most important services to them.
- Isolation, particularly in rural areas, significantly affects confidence, wellbeing, and independence.
- Community-based support is most effective when it is **local, flexible, and built on trust over time**.

Routes to Outcome (to be tested)

- New channels for connecting people - .e.g. Zoom
- Partnerships with other social activities e.g. Parkrun
- Support groups for family members.
- Engagement with a broader set of demographics e.g. Young Adults, Ethnic Minorities
- Engagement with Primary Schools and children to raise awareness



Transport



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Intended Outcomes

Members are better able to get out, access services, and engage in their communities.

Why

Because without accessible and reliable transport, people with sight loss become isolated, excluded from services, and unable to participate in community life.

LLBS Member: “If you can’t afford transport, you’re isolated.”

Intended Direction

LLBS will prioritise transport as a **core enabler of independence and connection**, recognising that access to social groups, health care, volunteering, and daily life depends on the ability to get out and about.

Reason

- Transport is consistently identified as one of the biggest barriers for members..
- Cost and availability prevent people from attending groups, appointments, and services.
- Lack of transport increases isolation, anxiety, and poorer wellbeing.
- Inaccessible transport undermines the impact of all other LLBS support.

Routes to Outcome (to be tested)

- Partnerships with local and community transport providers.
- Securing funding to subsidise transport costs where affordability is a barrier.
- Working with partners to improve awareness and accessibility within existing transport services.
- Exploring flexible, local solutions tailored to rural communities.



Wellbeing



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Intended Outcomes

Members report improved wellbeing, confidence, and resilience.

Why

Because sight loss affects mental health, identity, and confidence, and wellbeing support must be ongoing, personal, and rooted in human connection.

LLBS Member: “There’s grief with sight loss — it’s not just practical, it’s emotional.”

Intended Direction

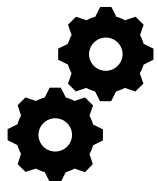
LLBS will prioritise wellbeing as a core part of living well with vision impairment, providing ongoing, person-centred support rooted in human connection, peer support, and trusted local relationships.

Reason

- Sight loss is often accompanied by grief, anxiety, and loss of confidence.
- Emotional impact can emerge at diagnosis or later as circumstances change.
- Isolation and reduced independence significantly affect mental health.
- Generic mental health services are often inaccessible, time-limited, or not sight-specific.

Routes to Outcome (to be tested)

- Social, creative, and activity-based groups that build confidence and connection
- Befriending and peer support for shared understanding
- Partnerships for sight-specific emotional and wellbeing support
- Funding to sustain and expand wellbeing activities over time



Future Ready



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Intended Outcomes

A resilient, well-governed charity able to support people for as long as needed.

Why

Because strong governance, effective systems, clear communication, and meaningful engagement are what make community support reliable, sustainable, and trusted. Ensuring LLBS can respond consistently, grow responsibly, and never let people fall through the gaps.

LLBS Member: "There's always someone at the end of the phone."

Intended Direction

LLBS will strengthen its foundations and ways of working, ensuring the organisation has the capacity, systems, and skills needed to support people consistently, respond to change, and grow responsibly.

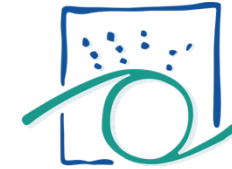
Reason

- Demand is increasing while capacity remains stretched.
- Reliance on a small number of individuals creates risk.
- Systems and processes must support safe, efficient, and accessible delivery.
- Clear communication and engagement build trust with members, funders, and partners.
- Strong operations enable all community, transport, and wellbeing work to succeed.

Routes to Outcome (to be tested)

- Strengthening governance, skills, and capacity across trustees, staff, and volunteers
- Improving systems, data, and digital infrastructure
- Clearer communication, branding, and engagement approaches
- Funding to support operational change and long-term sustainability

Income & Sustainability



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- **9.3% annual income growth** is needed to **maintain current services**.
- Delivering this strategy will require a further **~4%**, bringing total growth to **~13% per year**.

Why this matters

Demand for LLBS support is growing, particularly in rural communities. LLBS provides **preventative, community-based support** that improves wellbeing and reduces pressure on health and care services.

LLBS support 1 in 26 of the 42,000 people living with a vision impairment in Greater Lincolnshire. RNIB forecast the number of people living with a vision impairment in Greater Lincolnshire to raise to 52,000 by 2032.

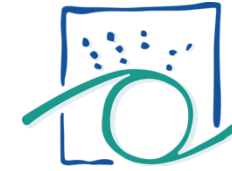
Our commitment

LLBS will grow income responsibly through strong governance, transparent use of funds, and a balanced funding mix.

Why Invest?

Investment in LLBS delivers proven local impact and contributes directly to **Lincolnshire's Joint Health & Wellbeing Strategy**.

LLBS Contributing to County-wide Health And Wellbeing Priorities



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The LLBS Living Well Together Strategy 2025-2030 is closely aligned with the Lincolnshire Joint Health & Wellbeing Strategy (JHWS) and contributes directly to its delivery at a local, community level for people affected by vision impairment.

Investment in LLBS:

- Supports **preventative, community-led outcomes**
- Reduces pressure on statutory health and care services
- Helps deliver Lincolnshire **JHWS goals locally** for a population at high risk of isolation and poor wellbeing

Mental health & wellbeing

- Ongoing emotional support, peer connection and confidence-building for people with vision impairments.

Prevention & early intervention

- Early, sustained community support that prevents isolation, declining wellbeing and loss of independence.

Support for carers and families

- Inclusive support for families and carers alongside individuals.

Physical activity & social connection

- Community groups and improved access (including transport) enabling participation and activity.

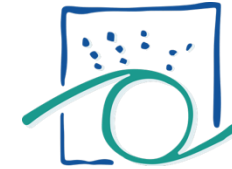
Reducing inequalities

- Reaching rural, isolated and under-served communities facing additional barriers.

Partnership & community-based action

- LLBS acting as a trusted local partner within the wider health and wellbeing system.

Join Us In Making a Lasting Difference



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Living well with vision impairment does not happen by chance, it happens when people come together with shared purpose.

If you care about inclusion, independence, and community, we invite you to be part of what comes next.

How You Can Help

- Share your voice, experience, or influence
- Give time, skills, ideas, or practical support
- Invest in trusted, community-led services with lasting impact
- Work alongside us to improve awareness, access, and understanding
- Help shape a future where no one faces vision impairment alone

Together, We Will

- Strengthen independence and wellbeing
- Reduce isolation and inequality
- Build inclusive, accessible communities
- Create lasting change across Greater Lincolnshire

This strategy is not something we deliver on our own. It succeeds because people choose to stand with us.

If you can help - in any way - join us by calling 01507 605604 or email info@llbs.co.uk
